9.6.2 ISS and International Cooperation

As great as the ISS' scientific achievements are, no less in accomplishment is the international co-operation which resulted in the construction of the ISS. An international collaboration of five different space agencies of 16 countries provides, maintains and operates the ISS. They are: NASA (USA), Roskosmos (Russia), ESA (Europe), JAXA (Japan) and CSA (Cananda). Belgium, Brazil, Denmark, France, Germany, Italy, Holland, Norway, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland and the UK are also part of the consortium.

Points to Remember

- The basic constituent of universe is galaxies which are really the collection of billions of stars.
- Scientists think that the universe began with the start of a massive explosion called the Big Bang.
- Depending on their appearance, galaxies are classified as spiral, elliptical, or irregular.
- Our Sun and all the planets in the solar system are in the Milky Way galaxy.
- A group of stars forms an imaginary outline or meaningful pattern on the space, called constellations.
- The Sun and celestial bodies which revolve around it form the solar system.
- Due to its right distance from the Sun, Earth has the right temperature, the presence of water and suitable atmosphere and a blanket of ozone.
- Millions of pieces of rocks that were left over when the planets were formed and now revolve around the Sun are called asteroids.
- A body moving in an orbit around a planet is called satellite.
- The ISS is intended to act as a scientific laboratory and observatory. Its main purpose is to provide an international lab for conducting experiments in space.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Asteroid	Small, rocky object orbiting the Sun.
Comet	A chunk of dirty, dark ice, mixed with dust which revolves around the Sun.
Constellation	A group of stars that can be seen as a pattern from Earth.
Galaxy	A group of stars, nebulae, star clusters, globular clusters and other matter.
Meteor	A meteoroid that travels through the Earth's atmosphere.
Meteorite	A meteor that hits the Earth's surface.
Milky Way	A broad band of light that looks like a trail of spilled milk in the night sky.
Moon	Any natural object which orbits a planet.
Planet	A relatively large object that revolves around a star, but which is not itself a star.
Satellite	Any object in outer space that orbits another object.
Space station	A large, manned satellite in space used as a base for space exploration.
Star	A ball of constantly exploding gases, giving off light and heat.
Universe	Everything in space, including the galaxies and stars, the Milky Way and the Solar System.

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